



IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 16: Significance of Citations in Public Speaking

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What is Citation?

- ❖ According to Merriam-Webster Dictionary, the word *citation* implies “an act of quoting”.
- ❖ However, citation does not merely include quoting excerpts or statements when it comes to public speaking.
- ❖ Rather, it also includes verbally acknowledging someone’s idea, work, contributions, findings, report, etc.
- ❖ It is an ethical duty for a speaker to provide the audience with access to the source in any form of presentation medium.



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Oral Citation vs Written Citation

Oral Citation	Written Citation
1. Source should be fully cited with reference to the author's name, title and date of the source—following the quotation or paraphrase employed during public speaking.	1. In-text citation is usually included, within the body of the written report. Full-length citations are usually attached only at the end of the document.
2. Example: Stephen Lucas in the tenth edition of his book <i>The Art of Public Speaking</i> published in the year 2008 speaks of the redundancy of saying statements like “As I found on the Web (or) According to the Internet”.	2. Example: Public speakers usually refrain from citing sources as referring to be borrowed from a larger and unreliable domain like the Web or Internet. (Lucas 41) – In-text citation MLA Style Full citation: Lucas, Stephen. <i>The Art of Public Speaking</i>. McGraw-Hill Education, 2008, p. 41.



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Be a/an (In)Credible Speaker

- ❖ In the first week's lecture on public speaking and ethics, we discussed the importance of ethics in carrying the message of the speaker.
- ❖ The evidential support from authentic sources would boost their own unique message uttered in public speaking.
- ❖ An experienced speaker would show themselves as different from ordinary speakers by equipping credible sources for supporting their delivery.
- ❖ Thus, a public speaker is entitled to trace out the authenticity of sources mentioned through means of “oral citations”.



Creating Credibility

- ❖ While delivering the speech, the speaker is bound to orally cite the sources from which s/he is quoting (or) rephrasing.
- ❖ Unlike in writing, the oral citation as a task demands memory retention of the speaker.
- ❖ Oral citation gives a strong outlook and support to the speaker - giving them a credible and reliable image amongst listeners.
- ❖ The value of credibility does not just add on to the speaker but also to the topic of concern and keep listeners interested and intuitive.

Why Cite Orally?

- To put it in simple terms, to avoid plagiarism and generate reliability.
- A public speaker cannot speak everything out of their original thoughts.
- Most of the time, public speaking as an event, addresses an issue of pressing concern.
- Given such a situation, a proper background research on the topic becomes necessary.
- The information gathered from these sources should be cited properly as a reference to audience.



Preparing Oral Citations

- Employing oral citation in speech provides an outlook amongst audience that the speaker has researched well on the topic.
 - Prepare a full reference list of works consulted and referred for your public speaking event.
 - The reference list will be helpful when audience raises doubts or questions.
 - If using visual aids, prepare few slides of written citation in a proper format.



What is Cited Orally?

- Employing oral citation in speech provides an outlook amongst audience that the speaker has researched well on the topic.
- Following is the common list of data which are cited orally:
 - Quotes
 - Statistics
 - Research Findings
 - Survey Reports
 - Laws and Regulations
 - Government Orders (G.O.)

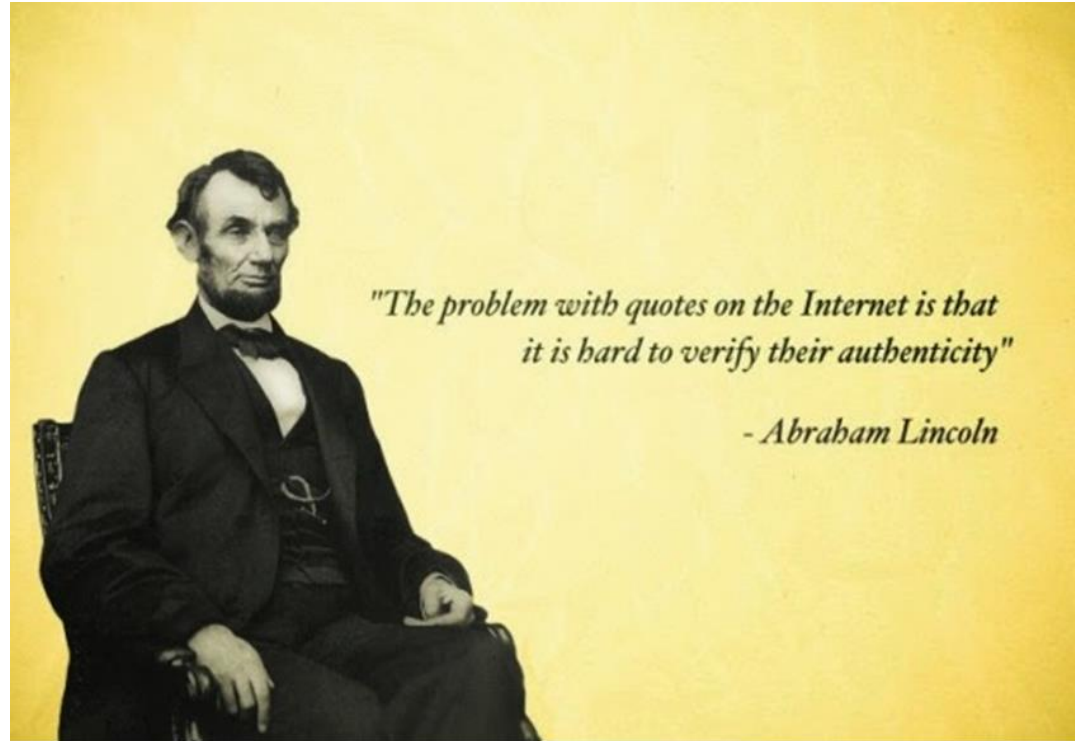
“Truth isn’t always beauty, but the hunger for it is.” —Nadine Gordimer

Those moments you fail are not the end, they are periods in which you recollect thoughts, ideas, and ambitions, and change direction.
-Benjamin Chapin, Think Positive: Guide to Positive Thinking



Quoting

In public speaking, whenever a speaker quotes words of importance from prominent speakers of the past, the speaker of concern is ethically obligated to cite the owner of the original quote.



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How to Quote with Oral Citations?

- When a speaker quotes, s/he quotes that particular statement word-for-word.
- Thus, a speaker is supposed to cite the source particularly as follows:

For example: If the quote is from A.P.J Abdul Kalam's biography titled *Wings of Fire* claiming **"We are all born with a divine fire in us"**, then a public speaker shall use it as follows:

1. In the book *Wings of Fire*, A.P.J Abdul Kalam has said [quote]
(OR)
1. As AP.J. Abdul Kalam said that [quote] in his biography *Wings of Fire*.



Paraphrasing

- Similar to quoting, when a public speaker uses ideas of another person but rephrases it in his own words then it is called as **paraphrasing**.
- Paraphrasing is a common tool employed by prominent speakers.
- It also has an advantage over quoting, i.e. one does not have to remember the line word for word by heart.
- One can even add their own style and humor while paraphrasing the borrowed ideas.



How to Paraphrase with Oral Citations?

Example:

If one is referring to this particular point **“Each minute of speaking time requires one to two hours of preparation time—perhaps more, depending on the amount of research needed.”** (Lucas 12)

One shall paraphrase and orally cite it as,

“Stephen Lucas emphasizes on the need for intense background research and hours of preparation before final presentation in the first chapter of his book *The Art of Public Speaking*”



Things to include in Oral Citations

A public speaker should address three major questions of **(who, what, when)** regarding the borrowed source to the listeners.

Who

Name of the Author along with the credentials.

- In 2009 issue of *Communication Skills for Engineers and Scientists*, **Binod Mishra** and **Sangeetha Sharma** addressed various areas of communication bordering on Indian situations.

What

Title/ Event

- In 2009 issue of ***Communication Skills for Engineers and Scientists***, Binod Mishra and Sangeetha Sharma addressed various areas of communication bordering on Indian situations.

When

Date of Publication/ Utterance

- In **2009** issue of *Communication Skills for Engineers and Scientists*, Binod Mishra and Sangeetha Sharma addressed various areas of communication bordering on Indian situations.

Cautions while Oral Citations

- Do not give a general source of information such as the Internet, library etc.
 - Never use “According to the [Internet]” as a catchphrase for oral citations.
- Do not orally state page number, web address type of details.
- Avoid repetitive usage of full oral citations.
 - After the first complete oral citation, it would suffice to mention the name of the author only.
- Never read the complete written citation word-for-word during public speaking.



“Credibility is a leader’s currency!”

- John Maxwell

"The smallest seed of faith is better than the
largest fruit of happiness." - Henry David
Thoreau

Thank You



Works Consulted

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